

DON CASTILLO

Full Stack Software Engineer

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Full Stack Software Engineer with 5+ years of professional experience building responsive web applications, cross-platform mobile apps, and scalable CMS solutions, including 3-4 years of hands-on experience with React and TypeScript. Delivered measurable impact including a 90% reduction in network bandwidth and a multilingual mobile app deployed across 17 countries in 23 languages. Proficient in React, TypeScript, Node.js, Python, and AI-assisted development workflows including Claude Code and GitHub Copilot.

HIGHLIGHTS OF QUALIFICATIONS

- 5+ years of full stack development experience across web, mobile, and CMS platforms, including 3-4 years working directly with React and TypeScript
- Architected and deployed a cross-platform React Native app used across 17 countries in 23 languages
- Delivered a 90% reduction in media bandwidth consumption through strategic asset optimization at scale
- Proficient in React, TypeScript, Node.js, Python, Flask, MySQL, Docker, React Native, Hugo, Svelte, and Directus
- Hands-on experience integrating AI tools (Claude Code, OpenAI API, GitHub Copilot) in production environments
- Led CMS migration of 20+ websites from Hugo static to Directus-backed headless architecture
- Strong academic foundation: BSc Computer Science (Great Distinction), Diploma in CIT (Honours)
- Experienced in agile teams, code review, intern mentoring, and cross-functional collaboration

TECHNICAL SKILLS

- **Languages:** JavaScript (ES6+), TypeScript, Python
- **Frontend:** React, React Native, Next.js, Svelte, Hugo, Tailwind CSS, Bootstrap, JQuery
- **Backend:** Node.js, Express, Flask, Knex, PHP, Django
- **Databases:** MySQL, MongoDB, PostgreSQL
- **Mobile:** React Native, Expo, Android Studio (Android & iOS)
- **DevOps & Cloud:** Docker, Git, Netlify, Digital Ocean, WHM, Cloudinary, Linux
- **CMS & APIs:** Directus, Stripe, Postmark, OpenAI API
- **Tools:** Claude Code, GitHub Copilot, VSCode, Postman, Redux

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Software Engineer (Full Time)

Apr 2021 – Present

Tangle Media | Lethbridge, AB

- Lead the company's Hugo web development practice as primary engineer, guiding full stack architecture from Directus CMS backend to Hugo static frontend and driving technical decisions across all client sites
- Spearheaded the migration of 20+ client websites to a modern headless CMS by conducting vendor research, standardizing content modules, writing automated data migration scripts, and streamlining deployment through Netlify CI/CD
- Resolved chronic page load issues across all client sites by designing a Cloudinary-based media optimization pipeline, slashing network bandwidth consumption by 90% while maintaining full uptime of media asset delivery
- Enabled non-technical clients to manage complex content independently by building responsive, SEO-optimized Hugo websites with custom theme switching, relational rich-text editing, and third-party integrations
- Cut project delivery from months to weeks by engineering versioned, installable CMS and frontend packages, standardizing full stack workflows through CI/CD, and creating reusable backend and frontend boilerplates
- Took multiple clients from zero online revenue capability to fully operational storefronts by developing end-to-end e-commerce solutions with Stripe payment processing and Postmark transactional emails

- Accelerated intern onboarding and raised team code quality by introducing structured mentorship through regular walkthroughs, code reviews, pair programming, and workflow documentation

Junior Web Developer (Internship)

Feb 2019 – Apr 2021

Tangle Media | Lethbridge, AB

- Converted visual design prototypes into production-ready Hugo websites; migrated legacy LAMP stack sites to JAMstack architecture
- Performed front-end troubleshooting on client websites and company CMS (Telegraph); participated in bi-weekly sprint reviews

Research Assistant – Full Stack Mobile App Developer (Part Time)

May 2023 – Present

University of Lethbridge, Dept. of Health Sciences | Lethbridge, AB

- Designed and launched GAC-PAQ, a cross-platform mobile data collection app for an international research study, achieving an average of 315 monthly active users across Android and iOS, with +31% MAU growth and +103% increase in new participant downloads
- Engineered multilingual, culturally adapted interfaces supporting 23 languages with locale-aware UI patterns and age-appropriate UX, ensuring consistent and accessible data collection across all 17 participating countries
- Implemented an offline-first architecture through efficient memory management and local storage strategies, ensuring uninterrupted data collection for participants in remote or low-connectivity regions
- Built a secure backend admin portal enabling research stakeholders to retrieve, manage, and monitor collected data from a single centralized interface across 17 countries
- Drove app adoption and ensured data integrity by conducting iterative closed testing with 30-40 remote testers and delivering multi-format technical support through email, video tutorials, and live demos

Co-Founder & CTO (Early-Stage B2B InsurTech Startup)

Aug 2025 – Present

MarkBound | Lethbridge, AB

- Co-founding and leading technical strategy for MarkBound, overseeing full stack architecture decisions and driving the product from concept to development
- Architected and scaffolded a role-based web application for insurance brokers, implementing multi-role authentication (admin, principal, and broker) and building the skeletal structure for form submission pages and a management dashboard using Next.js, React, and TypeScript
- Preparing to integrate the OpenAI API to auto-generate AI-driven insurance coverage recommendation forms tailored by industry, with search and filter functionality for past submissions

EDUCATION

Bachelor of Science in Computer Science, Minor in New Media

Apr 2024

University of Lethbridge, Lethbridge, AB — Graduated with Great Distinction

Diploma in Computer Information Technology

Apr 2019

Lethbridge Polytechnic, Lethbridge, AB — Graduated with Honours

CERTIFICATIONS (IBM / COURSERA)

- Django Application Development with SQL and Databases — Jul 2026
- Developing AI Applications with Python and Flask — Jul 2026
- Python for Data Science, AI & Development — Jul 2026
- Developing Back-End Apps with Node.js and Express — Mar 2026
- Developing Front-End Apps with React — Feb 2026
- Getting Started with Git and GitHub — Jul 2025
- Introduction to Cloud Computing — Apr 2025
- Introduction to HTML, CSS & JavaScript — Apr 2025
- Introduction to Software Engineering (with Honors) — Mar 2025